



Figure 4: New text selection and management tool

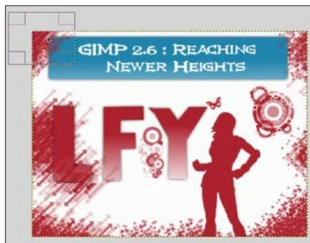


Figure 5: Pan beyond border

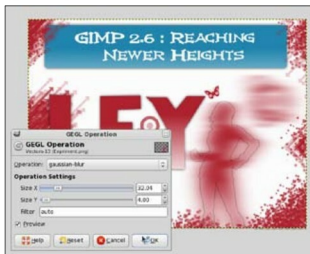


Figure 6: GEGL operations

yet finished the integration. GIMP, by default, still thrives on 8-bit colour support. There are no documents available for GEGL, or to be precise, the documentation team hasn't yet released documents for the new version.

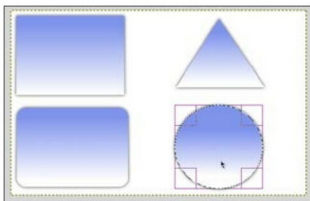


Figure 7: Different shapes in GIMP

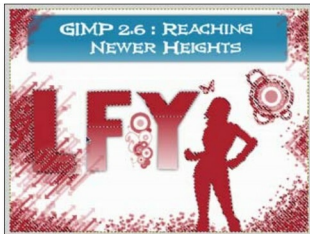


Figure 8: Colour select tool in action

You can activate GEGL from *Colours*→*Use GEGL*.

There are only two operations possible with GEGL—one, to enable it, and the other can be accessed from *Tools*→*GEGL Operations*. This option has lots of options like Gaussian Blur and White Balance, to name a few.

Additionally, GEGL operations and plug-ins are sluggish as compared to old plug-ins. A newbie will surely get confused with what GEGL is all about. Though the GIMP 2.6 launch announcement does promise better inter-portability of GEGL and with version 2.8.

Apart from these major changes, there have been modifications in existing tools. So let's take a look at some of the better plug-ins that come along with GIMP 2.6

GIMP selection tools

One of the unique tools that can give Photoshop a run for its money is the selection tool provided by GIMP. Well, of course, PS also has selection tools. However, what makes GIMP tools unique? The ability to resize even after making a complete selection. In addition to this, GIMP's rectangular selection tool has the ability to add curved edges in a few clicks, which makes your